DRAFT : Self Assessment Questions : for Museums or Cultural Setting

Question	Answer	Comment	Other
Have you got a space that you can offer as a dedicated class base for the primary school class residency duration?		Note : with cupboards too for the day's work table clearance etc, you can still share space out of class hours, eg. for Events / other users	
If you do not have a (class) room per se, could you create a "pop-up" classroom on site somewhere?			
Can you offer dedicated toilets for the children? Or will they need to be shared - with museum staff? - with public?		Don't worry! This can be managed once planned. We have made all scenarios work to date.	
Where will the children eat? - can you offer dedicated space? or shared space? - can you offer lunch? or any other food and refreshments?		This can be managed; it could be that some children are entitled to free school meals. Eating is a great potential social learning opportunity.	
Where can the children play and exercise? Do you have outdoor play and indoor play space (bad weather) available?		A change of scene to let off steam is what is needed.	

Question	Answer	Comment	Other
How will classes reach you? - can they walk? ideal! - can parents bring and collect? - do you need to think of public transport or school bus?		Make the journey part of the Learning opportunity about Place and Community. Keep fit if walking!	
Are your opening hours compatible? - how can they be collaboratively optimised?		The school may need access from, say 08.30am If you open at, say, 10.00am rather than earlier; can you make a “back door” and part of the premises available for a quiet start to the day? Projects to date have often had registration at school and then travelled; returning to school for close of the day story time etc..	
Can you offer Learning Officer time to actively participate: - for teacher training/guidance on your Collection or setting? - for project Interpretation and Collection setting stories? - to support/relieve class teachers at break time?		We have found that both MLOs, other museum personnel and school teachers have mutually developed programmes and good working relations as colleagues both during the project and in terms of onward projects and visits. MLOs have learned a LOT about teacher / class requirements and how to develop current content.	

Question	Answer	Comment	Other
Can you see any funding shortfalls to run the project? - or can you re-adjust budget priorities for the project duration?		There could be the opportunity to apply for funding with some cultural or professional support. Projects to date have cost less than you think!	
What is stopping you from running a MPSM project?		The risk will reap rich rewards!	